



HEALTH SERVICES SECTOR DEVELOPMENT PROJECT

July | 2021 Edition

NEWSLETTER

“HEALTH IS EVERYBODY’S BUSINESS!”

INSIDE THIS ISSUE

PAGE 2	HSSDP Civil Works
PAGE 3	AMBUNTI HC - ESP
PAGE 4	POMIO DISTRICT HOSP. WNBP
PAGE 5	KOPIAGO HC - HELA
PAGE 6	HMM TRAINING - JIWAKA
PAGE 7	HMM TRAINING - GULF
PAGE 8	COMMUNITY ENGAGE- MENT, WARASIKAU - WS
PAGE 9	COMMUNITY ENGAGE- MENT, IHU - GULF
PAGE 10	COMMUNITY ENGAGE- MENT, KUNUA - AROB
PAGE 11	COMMUNITY ENGAGE- MENT, TALYOKOS - ENGA
PAGE 12	GAULIM COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT, - ENBP

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MANAGERS MESSAGE



The Health Services Sector Development Project (HSSDP) aims to support the National Department of Health and Provincial Health Authorities to provide affordable, accessible, equitable and high quality services for all citizens with its projects deliverables.

This edition highlights activities undertaken by HSSDP over the past year till now.

Year 2020 and the first half of this year was a challenging time for everyone in the National and Provincial Offices due to COVID-19 lockdown. Most of our international staff were not able to travel due to quarantine restrictions that affected the project's activities both in the National and Provincial levels.

The lockdown affected the roll-out of project's activities such as human resources, health information systems and support for improvement of the national pharmaceutical and medical supplies procurement, warehousing & distribution systems and the suite of development trainings.

Despite the given situation, HSSDP has completed the project's safeguards and confirmations of land at several greenfield sites with Provinces, prior to tenders and constructions for the proposed health facilities. Currently, Pomio District Hospital, Ambunti District Hospital and Kapiago Health Centre are under constructions.

It is a challenging time where project activities are being delayed and with lockdowns due to covid is affecting the implementation of most of the project outputs.

On behalf of the National Department of Health and HSSDP, I would like to thank Ms Vicki Assenheim on her contributions towards the project and support she has given to the people of PNG. Ms Assenheim has left in the beginning of this year.

Project updates are highlighted for your perusal in this news.

Enjoy reading!

Rob Akers
Project Manager



HSSDP CIVIL WORKS



Left picture above: 3D view showing an example of a similar design of Mabudawan Health Centre in Western Province. Middle picture: An example of Urban Clinic in 3D view. Right picture: A 3D view of a Community Health Post. © HSSDP | 2021

Health Services Sector Development Project (HSSDP) has a list of its identified health facilities ranging from District hospitals, health centres and community health Posts for development.

The Project is aimed to strengthen health services through policy reforms and direct investments in health systems to achieve result orientated outcomes within the rural sectors of Papua New Guinea (PNG) through the improvement of basic health services while saving lives of many suffering communities within the remote locations in PNG. It is designed to be implemented over a seven-year period with the outcomes of affordable, accessible, equitable, and high quality health services deliverable for all citizens in the rural communities of PNG. The program is also aligned with NDOH's National Health Plan (NHP) 2011–2020.

- ◆ Bogia District Hospital, Madang Province
- ◆ Pomio District Hospital, East New Britain Province
- ◆ Laiagam District Hospital, Enga Province (RPHSDP II)
- ◆ Kopiago Health Centre, Hela Province
- ◆ Gloucester Health Centre, West New Britain Province
- ◆ Ambunti Health Centre, East Sepik Province
- ◆ Agevairua Health Centre, Central Province
- ◆ Ihu Health Centre, Gulf Province
- ◆ Karap Health Centre, Jiwaka Province
- ◆ Kunua Health Centre, AROB
- ◆ Wirui Urban Clinic, East Sepik Province
- ◆ Gaulim Community Health Post, East New Britain Province
- ◆ Bitokara Community Health Post, West New Britain Province
- ◆ Warasikau Community Health Post, West Sepik Province
- ◆ Talyokos Community Health Post, Enga Province
- ◆ Maramuni Community Health Post, Enga Province
- ◆ Gasmata Community Health Post, West New Britain
- ◆ Kapou Community Health Post, Manus
- ◆ Kinjibi Community Health Post, Western Highlands Province
- ◆ Umba Community Health Post, Morobe

The re-development of health facilities will promote client focus which will be a challenge to most of our health staff in the country. This is an ideal opportunity for our health staff to change the work practices at different wards, units and departments for improving our health indicators and hygiene of the health facilities both inside and outside.

This initiative will also address, staff capacity building, improved medical supplies and staff housing. Different levels of health facilities will receive different numbers of staff houses. It will also include integrated suite of development programs that will include specific clinical upskilling courses for health workers and upskilling in sexual and reproductive health practice.

The Government is interested in building new health facilities on state land only or in a partnership arrangement with any church organisation to improve health services that is in-line with ADB criteria. There will be no development on customary land and on land that are going through land disputes, or on land that is being contested by individuals or groups claiming to be land owners. There will be no development at the sites selected if the project feels that its safety or the safety of the contractors are at stake. The project will also pull out if there are issues at the sites that may be seen as threat to the health staff and the contractors. This project is not for any individual or not funded by any individual or Members of the Parliament



AMBUNTI HEALTH CENTRE - EAST SEPIK



Above picture: Ambunti Health Centre under construction, ESP.
© HSSDP | 2021

Ambunti Health Centre is going through an exiting transformation that most people at the station enjoy to watch. Old buildings that once occupied the premises of Ambunti Health Centre has been pulled down.

The design of the Health facility is adapted from Mabudawan HC in Western Province which was commissioned and opened in 2020 under the Management of Rural Primary Health Services Development Project.

The construction is within the existing health centre and it includes; the main building with 18 acute beds, a waiting house for expectant mothers, amenities for guardians, generator and incinerator sheds, 16 staff houses and other support buildings.

All buildings were designed and are constructed in accordance with the National Health Service Standards and the Building Code of PNG that regards engineering, environment safety, security and spatial efficiency aspects of the health facilities.

The design facilitates person centred care that includes; prevention of infection & control, fire control, accident prevention and disabled access through ramped entrances and adapted amenities such as bathrooms. Low-carbon and energy measures, including solar power generation and solar hot water supplies.



Old buildings of Ambunti Health Centre that has been pulled down for an upgrade. © HSSDP | 2021

It is after 50 years since Ambunti Health Centre has been given the real makeover to meet the Level three standard of the National Department of Health Standard.

This project will bring restoration of accessing basic health services that has been omitted in the rural and remote fraternity for the past years in the district and its surrounding communities that needed it most.



Above picture: Beginning of construction at Ambunti Health Centre.
Picture below: Front view of Ambunti HC under construction.
©HSSDP | 2021.



Picture below: Community consultation, Ambunti Station, ESP.
© HSSDP | 2019



From consultations, negotiations, partnerships and land confirmations over the years, Ambunti has finally come to enjoy watching the physical structures being put together.

Women living in the vicinity of Ambunti station has expressed their excitement of watching how change has taken place day by day. The women said that they have the desire to see the finish product and wonder how it would look like. Most importantly, the women are eager to see doctors, HEOs or nurses providing services in their new Health Facility once it is finished.

An elderly women said, “the time to travel Wewak to go to Boram Hospital shall come to pass, we want more qualified health workers to ease the burdens faced by lots of mothers of our surrounding communities.”



POMIO DISTRICT HOSPITAL AT PALMALMAL

The new Pomio District Hospital is situated at Palmalmal Town not too far from Palmalmal Health Centre and is at the opposite site of the road in Pomio District, East New Britain Province. It is also not far from the main District Administration office and is 16 hours on a ship to Rabaul and about 50 to 60 minutes by air on a small engine plane from Rabaul to Jacquinot Bay.

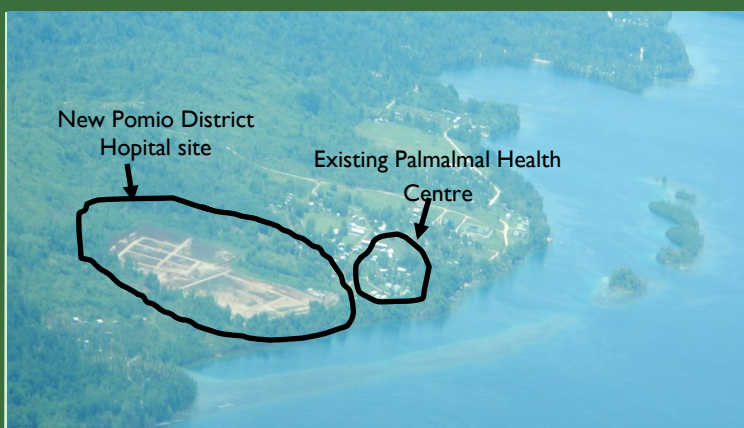
Palmalmal Health Centre is being upgraded to a level 4 District Hospital which is now the new Pomio District Hospital. HSSDP is currently managing civil works of the new Pomio District Hospital. The civil works include; a new Pomio District Hospital building with 40 acute beds, 26 three bedroom staff houses and five times two (2) bedroom duplexes, all constructions are in line with the National Health Services Standards and the PNG Building Code.

The new District Hospital will provide a range of health services expected of a Level 4 District Hospital, and will be housed with various health staff that will offer quality health services.

This project includes modern equipment such as x-ray and dental machines, sterilizer, infant warmers and a morgue that will make work easier for health workers. It will ease the burdens faced by the majority of the people of Palmalmal with transport difficulties and emergencies to Rabaul that are often delayed due to bad weather conditions and transport schedules



Above picture features the construction progress of the new Pomio District Hospital at Palmalmal, ENBP. © HSSDP | 2021
Pictures below shows construction progress of the new Pomio District Hospital at Palmalmal, Pomio District, ENBP. © HSSDP | 2021.



Above Picture: Aerial view of the new Pomio District Hospital. © HSSDP 2021

The aim for building Pomio Hospital is to ensure access to higher acuity health care and treatment for the people of Pomio District consistent with the PNG Health Service Standards, 2011.

It will serve the most disadvantage people in the district that live further inland of Pomio, Melkoi, Uvol and Mamusi plateaus. The people living in those areas have limited opportunities to access basic services including basic health services.

It will also improve maternal and child health services and address child malnutrition.

The health facility will also operate as a referral health facility accepting patients for admission and assessment from the health network across Pomio District. It has a sufficient reticulated water supply with back up water tanks and adequate supply of electricity supported with back-up generator and solar power supply.

ENBPHA will ensure effective delivery of essential healthcare services is not interrupted and that the health facility is fully staffed with qualified health staff to provide services that is needed.

A milestone and a stimulating era that will heighten health services and improve health indicators in Pomio District and East New Britain Province.

Pictures below features construction progress of the new Pomio District Hospital. District, ENBP. © HSSDP | 2021.





KOPIAGO HEALTH CENTRE - HELA PROVINCE



Above Picture: Design view of Kapiago Health Centre. © HSSDP | 2021.

Kapiago Health Centre civil works design is another facility that adapted the design of Mabudian Health Centre. Kapiago HC is currently under construction managed by HSSDP. The construction includes; building of the main health centre with 18 acute beds, support buildings including a waiting house for expectant mothers, amenities for guardians, generator and incinerator sheds and up to 16 staff residences. All buildings will be constructed within the site of an old HC facility including the area that was set aside for future expansion.

All buildings are designed and constructed in accordance with the National Health Service Standards and the Building Code of PNG having regard to engineering, environmental, security and spatial efficiency aspects of the facilities. The design facilitates person centred care including infection prevention and control, fire control, accident prevention and disabled access through ramped entrances and adapted amenities such as bathrooms. Low-carbon and energy efficient measures, including solar power generation and solar hot water supplies will be installed.

Hela Provincial Health Authority will have to appoint qualified staff to fully staff the quality health facility for its people and for improving health services of their District and Province. It is a challenge that the PHA must tackle before commissioning and officially opening of the Health Centre once it is completed.



Kapiago Health centre is located in Koroba-Lake Kapiago District of Hela Province. It is one of the least developed and remote District in Papua New Guinea.



Aerial view of Kapiago Health Centre. The big white building on the far right is a new building. Other buildings are old and pulled down for re-development.

Aerial picture showing the old Health Centre Facility that is being pulled down and rebuilt.. Kapiago HC. ©HSSDP 2021



Above Picture: Instalment of posts for the main building.
Picture below: Part of the kitchen and laundry building under construction. © HSSDP | 2021.



Bad road condition is slowing down the construction progress of Kapiago Health Centre as at times vehicles get bogged down and materials are left on the road and carried on smaller land cruiser vehicles.



Above Picture: Materials offloaded on the side road. Left picture showing materials loaded on a smaller vehicle. Both pictures also depicts bad road condition from Tari to Kapiago. © HSSDP | 2021.

HEALTH MIDDLE MANAGEMENT TRAINING - JIWAKA



Jiwaka Provincial Health Authority implemented the Organisational Development Programs designed to upskill the health workers and Management staff of their health workforce. The CEO, Mr. Thaddeus thanked HSSDP for this program and said that the training has clarified the roles of the PHA Board and has build their capacity in advanced management skills. Jiwaka PHA Board members sat for a days work-shop in February where roles and responsibilities of PHA Board were clarified with clear explanations from the HSSDP Human Resource specialist. The PHA Board appreciated the information communicated and thanked the Health Services Sector Development Project. The Board has invited the Project to continue to work with Jiwaka PHA to help maintain and build Jiwaka PHA to a certain level.

More than 40 senior health officers of Jiwaka Province attended a four days HMMT at Jiwaka Resort that was facilitated by the HSSDP which was officially open and closed by the CEO of Jiwaka PHA Mr Thaddeus Turi. Mr Turi, thanked the Agencies responsible for financing HSSDP and also thanked HSSDP staff for the support given to the PHA and also for the high quality information in management which he believes will set a clear direction for Jiwaka to improve its health services.

The workshop was an eye opener for most of the Health Officers in charge of health facilities as it was the first time most of the officers attending such management training to help them run the facilities

Pictures below: Participants participating in group discussions and presentations during HMM training at Jiwaka. © HSSDP, 2021

FEW PARTICIPANTS LEARNING INSIGHTS

- ♦ As a manager I have learnt that I will no longer direct and dictate people what to do. True art of leadership is to get people to do work enthusiastically and not by dictating and controlling them.
- ♦ I have learnt different forms of leadership, and net-working with people and organizations.
- ♦ I have identified myself in the types of leaderships that was facilitated.
- ♦ Creating a good working relationship with staff in the organization.
- ♦ I was challenged by the cultural values, and I realized that it is what has been hindering the growth and success of our Country and our Province. For PNG we still practice our cultural norms that causes barrier to most of our achievements. We must have a better understanding of how we work with our non-nationals. We need to understand cultural differences in order to build good partnerships and healthy working environments for positive growth and impacts.



HEALTH MIDDLE MANAGEMENT TRAINING - GULF

On the 14th to 19th March 2021, Gulf PHA Board Members and Staff attended the Health Middle Management Training (HMM). The first day of the training comprised of the Gulf PHA Board Members and the training was mainly focused on the PHA Board. From the 15th to 19th March 2021, Managers and Senior Officers in the management positions attended the course including the Officers In-charge of the Health facilities in the Province.

The training was held at the Catholics Conference Center in Kerema Town.

The participants from the remote and rural areas were glad that they attended this training as most of the OICs at the health facilities are Community Health Workers (CHW) that never been upskilled or have never learnt about management skills to manage Health Centers, Health Sub-Centers or health facilities.

Gulf PHA CEO, Dr Wari thanked the Project for this training and has requested the project to continue give support to Gulf PHA with such information and training that is required to improve basic health services to the people of Gulf Province.

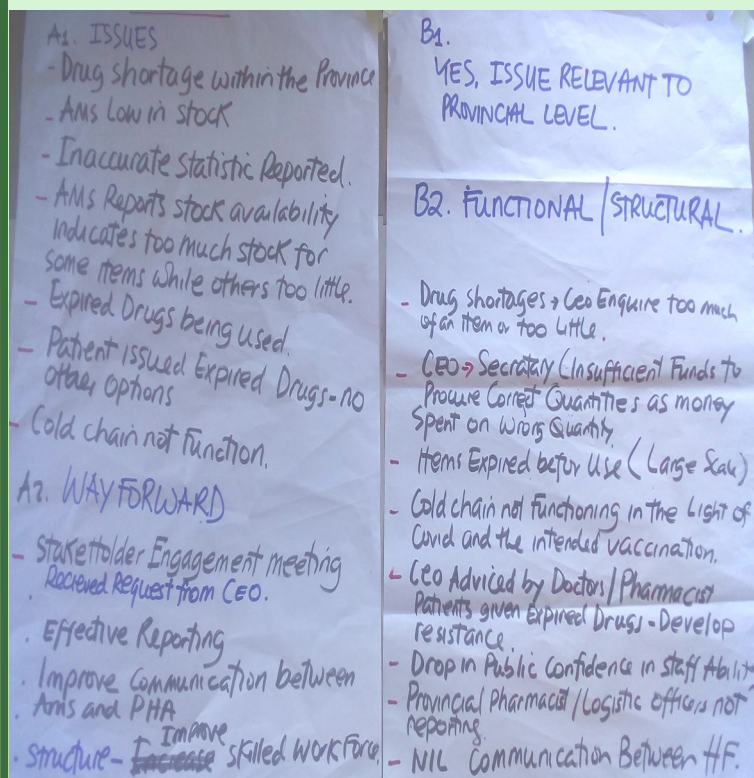
Pictures below: Participants participating in group discussions and presentations during HMM training at Kerema, Gulf Province.
© HSSDP, 2021



Participants group discussion session. © HSSDP, 2021



During group discussions, participants have identified issues affecting health services in their Province and have pointed out that the issues are relevant to the Provincial Health Authority to deal with as part of the case studies.



Participants case studies © HSSDP, 2021

In the case studies conducted in other Provinces, common issues have been popping up that were identified by participants, such as; lack of medical drug supplies, shortages of drugs at the health facilities, outdated drugs due to in-accurate reporting of statistics or no proper drug stock take record have been made resulting to patients been given expired drugs, drugs running out at Area Medical Store (AMS), too many drugs ordered not used or not many drugs needed are available and on stock

It is now up to the Gulf PHA to manoeuvre with approaches to underpin these issues.

The top five outcomes that were envisioned by the participants were;

1. Patient Centred Care or Patient focus.
2. Improved Funding
3. Improved Human Resources Capacity, (skills and manpower)
4. Improved Infrastructure, Equipment, Supplies and Communication.
5. Improved Leadership, Governance, Partnership and networking.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT –WARA SIKAU, WEST SEPIK

Women and Children listening to the Leaders expressing their enthusiasm during talks held at Wara Sikau. © HSSDP | 2021

Health Services Sector Development Project (HSSDP) safeguards and Health Communication officers visited Wara Sikau on 20th to 23rd of January 2021. Wara Sikau is a proposed Community Health Post (CHP) project in Nuku District of West Sepik Province to be managed by HSSDP.

HSSDP Staff conducted the safeguards assessment, environment and health needs assessment, and also carried out a survey of the health seeking behaviour of both men and women, with different peer groups of hamlets close to Wara Sikau.



Leaders of Wara Sikau community during the consultations.
© HSSDP | 2021



Above picture: Ward leader and young girls at Wara Sikau during the peer group discussions. Picture below: Men attending the consultation. © HSSDP, 2021



In the discussions held with different peer groups, it was mentioned; that people in the area do not go to health facility or to the nearest health facility to seek information about their health or health of their children or loved ones. The only time people go to health facilities is when they are very sick or ill and during emergencies and to deliver new born babies.

Most mothers in the interviews said that they decide to deliver at home because they fear the health workers due to their rude attitude and do not want to be sworn at where other women hears. “A woman who was among the group shared her experience of being sworn to by one of the nurses, and she has not returned after the incident.”



Men at Wara Sikau lead by their Ward Member. Wara Sikau Consultations.

Community members also commented that they do not trust health workers or have the trust to go to health facilities. However, people are enthusiastic about the new health facility as they have missed out on basic health services.

The woman representative of the community commented that if the CHP Project is successful and comes into their door way, it will ease all the burdens many mothers face like; dying along the road, giving birth along the way and transport difficulties which also comes in with bad road condition.

The community Leaders thanked the Project and Donors that are supporting this project and insisted that the project must reach their doorway to help their women and future generations access basic health services.

Children of Wara Sikau attending the community consultation. © HSSDP.2021

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT—IHU, GULF

On November 2020, the project team comprised of Mr Kelwyn C Browne, Mr Jim Dopo and Ms Dorothy Keyser Pais travelled to Ihu Station by boat that took about 2 hours 45 minutes. Two hours was spend at open sea and another 45 minutes from the sea to Vailala river heading to Ihu Station. Vailala river runs out to the sea and at times it is often hard to make it through due to weather conditions and where the river meets with the sea waves. Patients face hardships at that section because of waves. However the ride on the river is calmer than the ride at the open sea.

Ihu is in Kikori District of Gulf Province in Papua New Guinea. It is one of the remotest place in PNG and is situated along the Vailala river. The Government of PNG has proposed to build a new Level 3 health facility at Ihu Station to replace an old health facility.



Picture above shows a part way from Vailala river towards Lopekela Village.
Picture below: Raft floating on the main Vailala River. © HSSDP 2021



The Purpose of the trip was to confirm state ownership of the proposed site for the new Ihu Health Centre, to conduct baseline health seeking and receiving survey and to meet with members of the host community and selected catchment villages to identify current issues affecting health of the locals and health needs.

During the interviews with the four (4) villages, of Ihu catchment, Aro, Lopekela, Ihu Station and Auma villages, the people were very much excited about the proposed project and have requested for well trained doctors and nurses to be also included at the Health Centre is currently managed by a Community Health Worker (CHW). People said that they want to have a proper responsive and quality health care, that will help to cut down on unnecessary deaths that could be managed at a level three (3) health facility such as accidents and injuries, snake bites and deliveries.



The above picture showing a run down Health facility of Ihu Health Centre that is currently being used to provide health services. Ihu, Kikori District, Gulf Province. © HSSDP 2021



Above picture shows a run down Health facility of Ihu Health Centre that is currently being used to provide health services. Ihu, Kikori District, Gulf Province. Picture below features a wooden bridge to cross to go to the health facility. © HSSDP 2021



Picture below: Men and women of Lopekela village, attending a short brief & introduction of the Project team by the Lopekela Chief. © HSSDP 2021



Women at Auma village during a peer group discussion with project staff.
Ihu, Kikori District, Gulf Province. © HSSDP 2021

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT AT KUNUA - AROB

There has been several visits to Kunua Health Centre for land confirmations and health needs assessment, environment survey and community engagement since November 2020.

Trips taken by Project staff, Mr Kelwyn Browne, Mr Jim Dopo and Miss Dorothy Keyser Pais to Kunua has been successful, however the land is yet to be confirmed and land documents are to be handed to the project for the new proposed Health Centre Project prior to tenders and construction.

The majority of the people of Kunua are happy to have the new Health Centre Project erected at Sarime Plantation now known as the Kunua Plantation. The land size at the existing site is too small for the new Health Centre (HC) project.

The project is being shifted to the plantation area as there are plans underway for huge development to take place at Sarime plantation area since it covers more than a 100 hectares of land as explained by the District Manager for Kunua. Ten (10) hectares of land has been allocated for health.

The project is in line with the ABG plan and the National department of Health Plan 2011-2020.

The women of Kunua commented that this project is something which they have longed for. Many women die due to difficulties faced when delivering babies and some die along the way when they are transported to Buka Hospital. The women believe that this project may trigger changes in development and improved health indicators especially with maternal and child health.



Pictures above shows a group of children from Kunua that were around their parents during the first consultations with the people residing near Kunua Station. Below a group of in peer group discussion. © HSSDP2021.



Left picture, wet crossing at Savon Point towards Hahon before Kunua station. Middle picture: An old bridge at Hahon. Right picture: Boat push to open sea from the river bank. © HSSDP, 2021



Picture above. An old Kunua Health Centre Facility that is currently in use to deliver health services. Kunua District, AROB, PNG. © HSSDP, 2021

During the consultation and especially in private groups discussions the community members commented on the frustrations people face with the poor human resources at the existing health facility. Men and women made it clear that the quality of care currently delivered at the Kunua Health Centre is poor. Requests for quality care, proper examination of patients with various ailment or illnesses, specialist doctors was made mentioned to be part of the new proposed project. The human cost of transport to Buka and death en-route was cited in all groups. People really want the new health service, with a new clinical team with qualifications and attitude focussed on care provision.



Pictures above and below shows men and women in group discussions. © HSSDP 2021



COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT AT TALYOKOS - ENGA

Enga PHA with its partners have come together proposing a new CHP for Talyokos to replace an old bush material aid post facility that has been sitting there for more than 30 years without any proper facelift. The proposed Talyokos Community Health Post project will involve the construction of a new health facility at Talyokos Wapenamanda District in Enga Province to meet the National Health Service Standards (NHSS). The civil works design is the approved Community Health Post (CHP) as per the CHP Policy and will include construction of the main health facility building with 6 acute beds, support buildings including a waiting house for expectant mothers, amenities for guardians, generator and incinerator sheds and 5 staff residences. All buildings will be constructed on a green-field site purchased by the State specifically for the health facility.

The current aid post situated adjacent to the new site is a bush material temporary facility without hygiene of sanitation facilities.



Picture above featuring some women during consultations.© HSSDP, 2021
Picture below: Site inspection of proposed land for Proposed Talyokos CHP.



The trip to Talyokos was purposely for environment safeguards and confirmations of land, health needs assessment of the seeking behaviour of both men and women.

Enga PHA team led by the CEO, Mr Aaron Luai travelled with the project staff to Talyokos and did the site inspection of the piece of land allocated for the proposal of the new CHP facility project. The team met with the customary land owners and the members of the community for land confirmation, safeguards, and health needs assessment.



Pictures above features Talyokos current serving aid post facility both inside and outside. Picture below on the left side are CHWs. Two are currently serving the people and 1 has retired© HSSDP, 2021

A community consultation was conducted with different peer groups. Most stories related back to the past where life was tougher with no good road, no proper bridge to cross over to go to get health care at other nearby health facilities and long distance of climbing the mountainous plains to access basic health services at Tsak Health facility due to no drug shortages or no health staff.

There is now an upgrade of the road, a bridge has been constructed which allows women to travel to Wapenamanda to seek medical care. Power is now installed which will be beneficial for the new CHP project.

Picture below: PMG Power installing power to Talyokos village.© HSSDP, 2021



GAULIM COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT –ENBP

A study on the health seeking behaviours of women and men towards primary health care was successfully completed in Gaulim catchment communities by the Social Safeguards Team of HSSDP, which was conducted on the 29th to 31st of March 2021.

Social safeguards assessments, environment surveys, clinical and National Health Service Standards baselines and community engagement were completed with support from the East New Britain Provincial Health Authority and Gazelle District Health Officers.

There are similar stories from previous community engagements and assessments conducted where local people are longing for better health service delivery to their local communities.

There were common issues raised by the community members during the consultations, relating to difficulties of transporting patients to referral health facility and travel distances for some villages that are far away which leads to deaths along the road.

Few discussions held with the younger group of boys was heart breaking as most parents or elderly people do not realise that the younger boys and girls are already watching sexual movies on line and are wrongly influenced by those explicit sex stuff on the internet. There is no control over the use of mobile phones and it is not healthy for our young generation's future. Apart from such finding, all members of the communities that were visited, want a quality health service for their people.



A Community Leader at Gaulim during the consultation.© HSSDP, 2021



Picture above features a run down building at Gaulim Health Centre, ENBP. © HSSDP, 2021



Above pictures: Current setting of Gaulim Health Centre. © HSSDP, 2021



Gaulim women posing for a shot at Gaulim Health Centre.© HSSDP, 2021

The people are striving for a better health facility that could address the most pressing issue of transport, and those who travel far distances to seek proper basic health services.

During the consultations, most of the women said that this project will also help to address difficulties faced by women especially with deliveries and child health. However, most commented that there is a huge need to improve manpower at the health facility and more focus to be given to clients as some people walk distances just to seek health services that are denied to them due to most aid post not having enough drug supplies or health worker may be sick and not at work or the health worker is not working. It was revealed during the assessment that people living in far distances walk for a days or two depending on the distance when they are very sick or when an urgency arises for a patient to be treated. At times these people are accommodated by villagers along the road while travelling to the health centre to seek medical care. These people should be given some time to recover before they are send back to their villages.